Privacy Policy

Your privacy matters to us. This policy explains how Darjo Community Alliance (Darjo, we, us or our) collects, uses, stores and shares personal information. It also explains how you can access or correct your information, make choices about its use, or raise a privacy concern.

We handle personal information in accordance with the Privacy Act 1988 (Cth), the Australian Privacy Principles and other privacy, health, aged care and disability laws that apply to our activities.



Who this policy covers

This policy covers people who use or enquire about our services, their families, carers and representatives, website visitors, workers, contractors, partners and other people we deal with. It applies to information collected through our website, forms, correspondence, meetings, referrals, assessments and service activities.

Our work includes care coordination and referrals, community and aged care support, health technology, education, consultancy, and quality and governance support. The information we need depends on how you engage with us.

Information we collect

Personal information is information or an opinion that identifies you, or could reasonably identify you. We only collect information that is reasonably necessary for our work. This may include:

- your name, preferred name, date of birth and contact details;
- emergency contacts, next of kin and details of representatives or guardians;
- referral, assessment, service and communication records;
- government identifiers, where collection is lawful and necessary; and
- your preferences, feedback and complaints.

Where needed, we may also collect sensitive information, including health and disability information, medical and mental health history, clinical assessments, mobility and support needs, cognition, safeguarding concerns, and care plans. This

may include cultural background, language and religious or spiritual preferences. Genetic, genomic or hereditary health information is collected only where relevant and necessary.

We generally collect sensitive information with your consent. We may collect it without consent where Australian law permits or requires this, including in certain serious threats to life, health or safety.

How we collect information

We collect information directly from you wherever reasonable and practicable. This may be through forms, assessments, service agreements, consultations, care planning, telephone calls, emails or other correspondence.

With your consent, or where otherwise permitted or required by law, we may also collect information from family members, carers, authorised representatives, guardians, health professionals, hospitals, care providers, referral organisations and government agencies.

When someone provides information on your behalf, we consider their authority to do so. Being a family member or next of kin does not automatically give someone authority to make decisions for you or access your information. We take reasonable steps to tell you about information collected from others, unless a lawful exception applies.

Why we use and share information

We collect and use your information to:

- answer enquiries and assess your needs and service eligibility;
- deliver or coordinate services, referrals, assessments and care plans;
- identify risks, respond to safeguarding concerns and support your safety and wellbeing;
- communicate with you and people authorised to support you;
- manage feedback, complaints, quality improvement and service evaluation; and
- meet applicable legal, regulatory, reporting and contractual requirements and manage governance and risk.

A contract does not, by itself, authorise a use or disclosure that privacy law does not permit. We use or share information for the purpose for which it was collected, or for another purpose where you consent or the law allows or requires it.

Depending on the circumstances, we may share relevant information with healthcare professionals, hospitals, aged care and community service providers, support workers, referral partners and your authorised representatives. We may also share

information with government agencies, regulators, auditors, legal advisers and technology providers, including cloud, software, data analytics and authorised AI providers.

We limit what we share to what is reasonably necessary and take reasonable steps to ensure recipients handle information appropriately and securely.

Your choices and consent

You can make general enquiries without giving your name, or by using another name, where lawful and practicable. We may need to identify you to assess your needs, coordinate care or provide particular services. If you do not provide necessary information, we may be unable to provide some services safely or lawfully. We will explain this where relevant.

Where we seek consent, we explain what information is needed, why it is needed, how it will be used and who it may be shared with. Consent must be voluntary, informed, current and specific. It may be recorded in writing, electronically or verbally. We do not rely on pre-ticked boxes or bundled consent.

You can ask questions, limit your consent or withdraw it by contacting our Privacy Officer. We will explain any effect on your services. Withdrawing consent does not reverse lawful handling that has already occurred or prevent handling that the law otherwise permits or requires. Using our website does not, by itself, mean you consent to every use of your information described in this policy.

Artificial intelligence and automated processing



We may use AI, data analytics and automated tools to help identify support needs, monitor services, identify risks and safeguarding concerns, generate alerts, and assist with service matching, referrals and care coordination.

These tools may use your demographic details, service records, health and assessment information, risk information, and support and wellbeing information. Their outputs may inform staff decisions about risk assessments, review priorities, referrals, safeguarding actions, support arrangements or access to services.

Darjo maintains human oversight of significant decisions affecting you. Automated tools support staff decision making and governance processes. You can contact our Privacy Officer to ask how a tool has been used in relation to your information, what information it used, and how human review contributed to a decision.

Information handled overseas

Some technology providers may store or process personal information outside Australia. Overseas access by support staff may also occur. Where this involves disclosure to an overseas recipient, we take reasonable steps required by Australian privacy law to protect your information, unless a lawful exception applies.

These steps may include assessing the recipient's privacy and security arrangements, limiting processing to authorised purposes, and contractual requirements for confidentiality and security.

Countries where overseas recipients are likely to be located: [Insert the verified countries, or a link to a current country list, before publication. If it is not practicable to identify countries, explain the circumstances.]

Keeping your information secure

We take reasonable technical and organisational steps to protect information from misuse, interference, loss, unauthorised access, alteration or disclosure. Depending on the information and system, safeguards may include secure storage, encryption, access controls, authentication, monitoring, audit logs, software updates and incident response procedures.

Access is limited to authorised people who need information for their work. Staff, contractors and representatives must meet confidentiality obligations.

If a privacy incident or data breach occurs, we take steps to contain it, assess the harm and address its cause. We notify affected individuals and the Office of the Australian Information Commissioner (OAIC) when required by the Notifiable Data Breaches scheme.

How long we keep information

We keep information for as long as it is needed for its lawful purpose or required by applicable recordkeeping laws. Relevant service, aged care, health, contractual, complaint and dispute requirements may affect this period.

When information is no longer needed and the law does not require retention, we take reasonable steps to securely destroy it or de-identify it. De-identification means

taking steps so the information is no longer about an identifiable person or someone who could reasonably be identified. We also take reasonable steps to reduce the risk of re-identification.

Our website and cookies

Our website may collect technical information such as your IP address, browser and operating system, pages viewed, referring website, and the date and time of your visit. We use this information to maintain security, understand website use, improve performance and resolve technical issues.

We may use cookies and similar technologies to support website functions and improve your experience. You can manage cookies through your browser settings. Blocking some cookies may affect how the website works.

Research and quality improvement

We may use information for research, quality improvement and service evaluation where permitted by law. We use de-identified information where practicable. Where identifiable information is needed, we obtain consent or rely on a lawful basis for its use. Research requiring ethics review is subject to the relevant approvals.

Accessing or correcting your information

You can ask to access the personal information we hold about you or ask us to correct information that is inaccurate, incomplete, out of date, irrelevant or misleading. Email our Privacy Officer with your request and enough detail for us to locate the information. We may need to verify your identity or a representative's authority.

We respond within a reasonable period. There is no charge to make an access or correction request. If a reasonable charge applies to providing access, we will explain it before proceeding. We do not charge to correct your information.

If we cannot provide access or make a correction, we will explain the reasons in writing, except where the law permits otherwise, and tell you how to complain. If we decline a correction, you may ask us to attach a statement recording that you believe the information is incorrect.

Privacy concerns and complaints

If you are concerned about how we have handled your information, contact our Privacy Officer. Describe what happened and the outcome you are seeking. You can ask someone authorised by you to help make the complaint.

We will acknowledge your complaint, investigate it and respond within a reasonable period. We will explain our findings and any steps to resolve the matter. If you are unhappy with our response, or have not received a response within 30 days, you can complain to the OAIC through www.oaic.gov.au.

Contact our Privacy Officer

Privacy Officer
Darjo Community Alliance
Email: admin@darjo.com.au

Contact us to ask about this policy, discuss consent, request access or correction, or raise a privacy concern. You can also request a free copy of this policy in another format. We will take reasonable steps to provide it in the form you need.

Changes to this policy

We may update this policy when our services, technology, information handling practices or legal obligations change. The latest version will be available on our website, with the date it was updated.